

One for the Chatterbox

Today most surfers use Yahoo!, MSN, ICQ and AIM. So what could be more brilliant than the idea of a single client, which could control all messenger accounts? Multiple messenger users find it extremely convenient to use such clients. Configuring Yahoo!, MSN, ICQ and AIM accounts is quite easy. Once the accounts are configured, your buddy lists are imported from the respective services. Now you can send/receive messages to all your buddies on different services from a single window.

Some of the most popular cross-platform mix messengers are Jabber, Trillian and Odigo. While Trillian and Odigo simply let you configure all your messenger

accounts, Jabber gives you much more. Jabber is an XML-based open source messaging client that can be used to configure Jabber and other messenger accounts. The mind blowing features of Jabber include accessing your Jabber account from anywhere using devices such as PDAs, mobile phones, etc, making it completely interoperable. The community is focused on enhancing this piece of software with features such as SMS services and wireless access. Jabber focuses more on security and privacy with no compromise on the ease of use. Jabber also allows you to set up your own chat server. Check out www.jabber.org and find out what interests you.

server. Your peer is notified with a link using which he/she could download the file from the server.

MSN opens a temporary peer-to-peer connection for the file transfer. Thus, when you send a file to your friend, a connection is established directly between your client and your friend's client. They communicate with each other without the intervention of the server, allowing for faster file transfers. But during network congestion this system may not work and hence a server intervention and store-forward mechanism is more worthwhile.

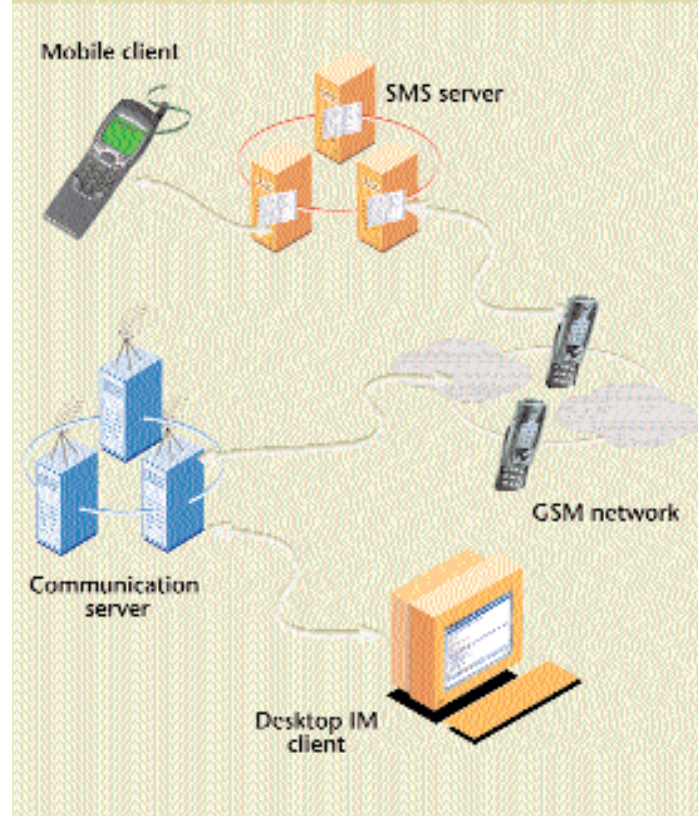
Most multimedia communication occurs via a buffering server, which stores and forwards digital information. Once you enable 'voice chat' the client contacts the communication server, which directs it to an audio server. The server immediately sends a notification to your friend that you would like to have a voice chat with him/her. If your friend consents, a voice communication channel is initiated between the two of you. Now you can use your microphone to chat. The voice

transmission of voice and video follow the same principle as an instant message.

Over one billion instant messages are exchanged **every day**

When you try to send a picture to your friend, a file transfer is initiated. The server checks for the file's size and if found to be too large, it denies a connection for the file transfer. If it is within the size limits, a session is initiated with your peer and the file is sent in small chunks. Some IM services upload files to the communication

Chat on the Move



Relaying a message from a mobile device to a desktop and vice versa

- 1. Authentication phase:** To chat using a mobile phone, send an SMS with your user ID and password to the service number provided by the mobile service provider. The SMS server that receives the SMS, routes it through the GSM network to the Yahoo! authentication server. The authentication server sends an authorisation ticket as an SMS back to your mobile phone. Simultaneously the Yahoo! communication server is notified that the user has logged onto the messenger using a mobile phone.
- 2. Instant Messaging phase:** Now the address on the communication server holds your mobile number, user ID and IP. You can chat with your friends by sending an SMS to their user IDs. The SMS server identifies that the SMS is an instant message intended for a Yahoo! client. The message is routed appropriately through the phone network to the Yahoo! communication server and is then relayed to the user.
- 3. Receiving messages from desktop clients:** Desktop messenger users can reply as you would reply to any other message that you receive. Since the address on the communication server notifies that the user is logged on using his mobile phone, the message is routed to the SMS server from where it is sent as an SMS to the mobile phone user.